

Roll of DISHONOUR

PRAVIN KUMAR JAIN

IRS

FIR: June 3, 1996

Then: Assistant Commissioner,
Central Excise, Dhanbad

Now: Dismissed from service

Date of Chargesheet:

June 24, 1997

Status: Under trial

SWARN SINGH

IRS

FIRs: January 21, 2004 and
February 23, 2004

Then: Assistant Commissioner,
Income Tax, Dhanbad

Now: NA

Date of Chargesheet:

March 2005, October 2006

Status: Under trial

J.P. KAUSHIK

C&CES

FIR: February 17, 1995

Then: Collector of Customs,
Karnataka

Now: NA

Date of Chargesheet:

September 29, 1997

Status: Under trial

RAJEEV GUPTA

C&CES

FIR: March 30, 2001

Then: Deputy Commissioner,
Delhi

Now: Additional
Commissioner, Delhi

Date of Chargesheet:

February 27, 2006

Status: Under trial

B.S. THIND

IPS

FIR: 2004

Then: ADGP, Himachal
Pradesh

Now: Under suspension

Date of Chargesheet:

October 28, 2006

Status: Under trial

A LOT TO

■ By Shyam Lal Yadav

India normally figures closer to the bottom in most rankings prepared by United Nations (UN) agencies. The UN Human Development Index, for instance, places India at 128th place, sandwiched between Equatorial Guinea and the Solomon Islands, while the UN World Population Prospects report on infant mortality puts India at a lowly 142, higher than Gabon but lower than Ghana. But there is one list, if ever compiled, in which India could perhaps aim for a place in the Top Ten, if not Top Five. The country is home to some of the most corrupt government officials anywhere in the world.

Since April 1, 1992, exactly 16 years back, the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has registered corruption cases against at least 163 officers from what is commonly known as India's steel frame—the Indian Administrative Service (IAS), Indian Police Service (IPS) and Indian Revenue Service (IRS) (including customs and central excise) officers. Yet, most of them continue to be in service, get promoted every few years and as happened last week, will see their salaries go up by as much as 50 per cent with yet another pay commission recommendation. Narayan Diwakar is a perfect example of how bureaucrats accused of corruption carry on with their normal lives without any fear of retribution. The 1966 batch IAS officer of Arunachal Pradesh-Goa-Mizoram and Union Territories (AGMUT) cadre (now retired) was posted as finance secretary, Daman and Diu when CBI registered three cases against him on September 29, 1993 under various sections of Indian Penal Code and Prevention of Corruption Act. It took another 11 years for the agency to file a chargesheet against him on June 24, 2004, a period during which Diwakar held important positions. The Department of Personnel and Training (DoPT), the cadre controlling authority for IAS, finally granted permission for initiating prosecution proceedings against him in those cases on April 28, 2004—two days before he was due to

PRAHLAD KUMAR AJWANI

C&CES

Was arrested on

September 25, 2004 on
charges of amassing
disproportionate wealth.

He was released on bail
on November 24, 2004.

Rs 2.71 crore
cash was recovered from
his and his relatives'
premises in July 2004.

Status:

**UNDER SUSPENSION
AND FACES TRIAL**

